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Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMMAD DISCUSSES REGIONAL ISSUES WITH SERBIAN PRESIDENT

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday met with Aleksandar Vucic, President of Serbia, at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi. Shaikh Mohammad expressed hope that the visit would help advance the ongoing development of relations between the two countries. The leaders exchanged views on a number of regional and international issues of mutual concern, particularly the latest developments in the Middle East.

13,000 join UAE's dollar millionaire resident base in 2024, says UBS

There has been an influx of Saudi, Indian, Chinese and UK high net worth individuals

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

An additional 13,000 made it to the ranks of UAE's dollar millionaire resident base in 2024, according to the latest UBS 'Global wealth Report 2025', which is an increase of 5.8 per cent from the year before. A good number of these newly created millionaire base in the UAE came about from relocations, as has been the case for four years now.

"This year there has been some significant movement in the number of millionaires in many of parts of the world, both upwards and downwards," according to the Swiss bank's findings.

"Having looked at long-term trends, we concluded that wealth is far from static."

240,343
dollar-millionaires
in the UAE, worth a
combined \$785m

In the UAE, that's been the case. Banking and property market sources talk about the multimillion dollar deals that have been shaping the UAE investment landscape.

Bigger deal sizes

The property firm Knight Frank in a recent report points to the influx of Saudi, Indian, Chinese and UK high net worth individuals committing sizeable investments in the UAE. At some locations such as Jumeira Bay island, the deal sizes are getting bigger.

There are an estimated 240,343 dollar-millionaires in the UAE with a combined \$785 million.

Saudi Arabia, according to UBS, has 339,029 dollar-

millionaires, with combined wealth holdings of \$958.3 million.

In the UAE, around 62 per cent of gross wealth is allocated to financial assets, and it's almost 58 per cent in Saudi Arabia. Assets such as real estate as well as land make up about 48 per cent of what the super-rich spend on in both the prime GCC markets. (Debt levels among these investors is close to 9 per cent in the UAE and 'only 5.7 per cent in Saudi Arabia, one of the lowest levels in our sample of 56 countries', according to UBS.)

Niels Zilkens, Head Wealth Management Middle East at UBS Global Wealth Management, said: "Saudi Arabia and the UAE are not only seeing rising millionaire numbers, but also meaningful gains in median wealth — especially in the UAE, where it rose over 23 per cent since 2020.

"With a combined \$122 billion in expected wealth transfers ahead, both markets are entering a pivotal phase of generational transition."

UAE leads efforts to de-escalate regional tensions

UAE PRESIDENT HOLDS TALKS WITH RUSSIAN AND IRANIAN PRESIDENTS

ABU DHABI

Gulf News Report

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan has been leading intensive diplomatic efforts aimed at de-escalating tensions and preventing the spread of the Israel-Iran conflict.

Through robust diplomatic engagement, Shaikh Mohammad seeks to promote dialogue and reject violence, reinforcing the UAE's long-standing role as a stabilising force in the region through diplomacy.

The President held a telephone call yesterday with Russian President Vladimir Putin. The two leaders discussed efforts being made to contain the situation and put an end to the escalation, stressing the importance of exercising restraint and pursuing dialogue to avoid further threats to security and stability. They underscored their support for all efforts aimed at achieving a solution through diplomatic means

Call with Pezeshkian

Shaikh Mohammad on Tuesday held a telephone call with Dr Masoud Pezeshkian, President of Iran, during which they discussed the latest developments in the Middle East and their grave implications for regional peace and security. Shaikh Mohammad expressed the UAE's solidarity with Iran and its people during these challenging times.

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Shaikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, warned against reckless actions and called on the United Nations and the Security Council to take urgent steps.

Shaikh Abdullah has led a series of intensive diplomatic consultations with several foreign ministers, reaffirming that calm dialogue and diplomacy are essential to prevent further escalation and maintain regional stability.

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the President, emphasised that diplomacy remains the most effective and least costly approach to addressing regional challenges. He expressed deep concern over the growing military tensions between Iran and Israel and warned of the dangerous momentum that armed conflict can create, leading to unpredictable consequences.

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SPORT
India's Rishabh Pant to continue playing at No 5 spot 'Kohli's No 4 position to be taken by Gill' | P13

Vehicle hits 650km/h in 7 seconds on maglev track

China sets a new world speed record

DUBAI

BY ANUPAM VARMA
Online Editor

Chinese researchers have accelerated a 1.1-tonne test vehicle on a maglev track to a top speed of 650 kilometres per hour in just seven seconds over a distance of 600 metres, setting a new world record in the process, according to the research team.

According to a report by China Central Televi-

sion (CCTV), the magnetic levitation (maglev) system, equipped with powerful electromagnetic propulsion and precise speed measurement and positioning capabilities, can bring a vehicle



to a complete stop from high speeds within just 200 metres of track.

This powerful acceleration and braking control make the high-speed maglev test track a vital platform for the research, development, and testing for China's high-speed railway network.

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